

Course Work Assessment - Alternative Assessment

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Contents

Introduction and Company Background.....	5
Company background:	5
Business Vision, Mission, and Objectives:	6
Situation Analysis	6
IT Organization Profile	6
IT Service Management Approach.....	6
IT and Business Alignment Issues	6
Current IT Governance Status.....	7
Enterprise Architecture.....	7
IT SWOT Analysis.....	7
Major IT & Business Gap Analysis	8
Gap 1: Poor Connection Between Online and In-Store Shopping	8
Gap 2: Reliance on Manual Processes in Supply Chain.....	8
Gap 3: Not Using AI-Driven Personalization	9
Gap 4: Cloud Security Needs to Be More Proactive	9
IT/Business Alignment Strategies and Actions	10
Proposed Solution for Gap 1: Poor Connection Between Online and In-Store Shopping	10
Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):.....	11
Proposed Solution for Gap 2: Reliance on Manual Processes in Supply Chain	11
Proposed Solution for Gap 3: Not Using Customer Data for Personalization	12
Proposed Solution for Gap 4: Cloud Security Needs to Be More Proactive	13
Part 2: Suggested Outline for the Industry Framework.....	15
Section 1: Framework Selection	15
COBIT 2019 Components	15
ITIL 4 Practices.....	16
Scope Boundaries.....	16
Section 2: Framework Implementation	16
Implementation Phases	16
TOGAF and ITG Framework Integration.....	18
The Relationship between TOGAF and the Selected Frameworks	18

Impact of Integration with Clear Examples.....	19
Status of ITIM (CLO5)	20
Conclusion.....	22
Reference	23
Appendix	25

Introduction and Company Background

This document explains the IT Strategic Plan and Governance Framework for Majid Al Futtaim Retail (Carrefour). It was created to guide the company's technology leaders and make sure IT projects support the main business goals, follow rules and regulations, and give the best value to technology investments over the next 3 to 5 years.

Company background:

Company Name: Majid Al Futtaim Retail

Brand: Carrefour (under an exclusive franchise agreement)

Size: Majid Al Futtaim Retail has more than 390 Carrefour stores in 16 countries. It employs over 37,000 people and serves more than 750,000 customers every day (Majid Al Futtaim, 2026). The parent company, Majid Al Futtaim, earned 9.2 billion USD in revenue in 2024 (Majid Al Futtaim, 2025).

Location: Headquartered in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, with operations across the Middle East, Africa, and Asia.

Products or Services

Carrefour offers many different products and services, making it a one-stop shop for customers. The main offerings are:

Category	Description
Groceries & Food	Fresh fruits and vegetables, organic items, frozen food, and packaged products.
Electronics	Home appliances, mobile phones, computers, and accessories.
Household Goods	Furniture, kitchen tools, home décor, and other daily home items.
Personal Care & Beauty	Cosmetics, skincare, and health products from local and international brands.
E-commerce & Delivery	Online shopping through the Carrefour app and website, with delivery available to most people in the UAE.
Loyalty Program	The SHARE rewards program, where customers collect points and get benefits across Majid Al Futtaim brands.

Customers and Target Market

Carrefour's target market is wide and diverse, including customers from many nationalities with different shopping habits and preferences. This makes it difficult to group customers only by nationality. Instead, the company needs to use advanced data analytics to better understand customer needs. Their customers include both budget-friendly families and high-end shoppers, so Carrefour must offer products and services that suit different income levels and preferences.

Business Vision, Mission, and Objectives:

Vision: To become a leading digital-first retailer that offers excellent and sustainable shopping experience across both online and physical channels for its customers.

Mission: Our goal is to offer many good products at fair prices, using new technology, running things efficiently, caring for the environment, and helping the community.

Top 3 Business Objectives

- **Lead in Digital Transformation:** Move from a regular store to a mostly online business, using e-commerce, data, and smooth shopping across all channels.
- **Enhance Customer Experience:** Make shopping easy, personal, and enjoyable for customers in both stores and online, with good loyalty programs and ways to connect with them.
- **Drive Operational Excellence and Sustainability:** Improve technology and processes, automate work, and take care of the environment while growing the business profitably.

Situation Analysis

IT Organization Profile

Carrefour's IT organization is designed to support both group-level strategy and retail operations. At the holding level, Elham Al Qasim, Chief Strategy & Technology Officer, guides the long-term technology vision (Majid Al Futtaim, n.d.). The retail division is led by Sunil Nair, CIO | SVP - Business Technology and Analytics, who brings over 28 years of experience in the field (RocketReach, n.d.). The organization includes specialized roles for data, analytics, and digital transformation, reflecting a mature structure. Leaders with certifications in PMP, ITIL, and COBIT demonstrate a commitment to standardized processes and best practices (LinkedIn, n.d.).

IT Service Management Approach

Carrefour's IT service management (ITSM) approach follows the ITIL framework. Leadership certifications and structured service delivery exemplify this focus, as seen in the 43% cost savings achieved in the contact center through Genesys Cloud (Genesys, n.d.). Core ITIL processes such as incident management, change management, and continual service improvement ensure stable, efficient, and high-quality IT operations.

IT and Business Alignment Issues

Despite progress in digital transformation, Carrefour faces alignment challenges in delivering a consistent customer experience across its expanding network of physical and digital channels. Rapid e-commerce growth places pressure on IT infrastructure, supply chain systems, and customer data platforms to remain fully synchronized with front-end operations. Any misalignment risks creating fragmented customer journeys, undermining the objective of enhancing satisfaction.

Current IT Governance Status

Carrefour's IT governance is evolving toward a formal, framework-based model. The implementation of a Cloud Governance Model during GCP migration marks significant progress (NTT DATA, n.d.). Adoption of the NIST Cybersecurity Framework further strengthens security governance (Carrefour Group, n.d.). Leadership requirements for TOGAF and COBIT certifications indicate a clear commitment to enterprise-wide governance that aligns IT with business goals and mitigates risk (Majid Al Futtaim Careers, n.d.).

Enterprise Architecture

Carrefour's enterprise architecture is guided by TOGAF (Majid Al Futtaim Careers, n.d.), ensuring that its complex ecosystem of data, applications, and technology is scalable, modular, and efficient. The architecture supports a hybrid, multi-cloud strategy (GCP, Azure, OCI) and integrates major platforms such as SAP S/4HANA (Oracle Blogs, 2021) and the IBM Netezza data warehouse (IBM, n.d.), providing a robust blueprint for future growth and technological evolution.

IT SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
1. Carrefour has strong executive commitment to digital transformation. 2. The company partners with leading tech vendors such as Google, IBM, and Microsoft. 3. It uses mature Enterprise Architecture (TOGAF) and IT Service Management (ITIL) practices. 4. Carrefour has scalable cloud infrastructure on Google Cloud Platform (GCP).	1. Omnichannel integration is incomplete, causing disjointed customer journeys. 2. Some supply chain processes are still manual, limiting efficiency. 3. Data silos exist between different business units and channels. 4. Rapid cloud migration has increased cybersecurity risks.
Opportunities	Threats
1. Use AI and machine learning to provide hyper-personalized experiences. 2. Fully automate the supply chain for faster and more cost-effective fulfilment. 3. Leverage SHARE loyalty program data to build a 360-degree view of customers. 4. Expand the retail media network (Precision Media) as a new revenue stream.	1. Intense competition from agile, cloud-native players such as Amazon and Noon. 2. Rising customer expectations for instant delivery, including 15-minute services. 3. Growing sophistication of cybersecurity threats targeting retailers. 4. Evolving data privacy regulations across different markets.

Major IT & Business Gap Analysis

This section identifies the critical gaps between Carrefour's current state ("AS-IS") and the desired future state ("TO-BE") required to achieve its strategic goals. Using the Gap Analysis technique, we document what is missing, what needs to change, and what must be added to move forward.

Gap 1: Poor Connection Between Online and In-Store Shopping

- **Description:** Carrefour's website, app, and physical stores don't work together smoothly. A customer might see an online promotion that isn't available in-store, or struggle to return an online purchase at a local store. Customer data from the SHARE loyalty program (SHARE Rewards, n.d.), online shopping, and in-store purchases is stored separately, so the company can't see the full picture of each customer. According to Adobe (n.d.), creating a unified customer profile is essential for brands to deliver true personalization at scale across all channels.
- **Justification:** Customers today expect a seamless experience across all channels. When online and in-store don't connect well, customers get frustrated. This leads to lost sales and makes people less loyal to the brand.
- **Impact on Business Objectives:**
 - **Objective 2 (Enhance Customer Experience):** This gap directly hurts this goal. A disconnected experience is the opposite of the "unified customer journey" that Carrefour wants to provide.
 - **Objective 1 (Lead in Digital Transformation):** Being digitally transformed doesn't just mean having a website and an app, it means making all channels work together as one. This gap shows that Carrefour isn't fully there yet.

Gap 2: Reliance on Manual Processes in Supply Chain

- **Description:** While Carrefour has automated some parts of delivery with Micro-Fulfillment Centers (Zawya, 2021) and deployed inventory robots in stores (Simbe Robotics, n.d.), much of the supply chain still relies on manual work such as forecasting demand, managing warehouse inventory, and restocking store shelves. The company's data infrastructure, including IBM Netezza, processes operational data 3x faster (IBM, n.d.), but this capability hasn't been fully extended to supply chain automation.
- **Justification:** Manual processes are slower, more expensive, and more prone to error than automated systems. Competitors with automated supply chains can deliver products faster and at lower cost. Carrefour is falling behind operationally.
- **Impact on Business Objectives:**

- **Objective 3 (Drive Operational Excellence):** Manual work increases costs and slows things down. That's the opposite of operational excellence.
- **Objective 1 (Lead in Digital Transformation):** A digital retailer needs a digital supply chain. This gap shows that while the customer-facing side is transforming, the operational core remains incomplete

Gap 3: Not Using AI-Driven Personalization

- **Description:** Carrefour collects lots of customer data through the SHARE loyalty program (SHARE Rewards, n.d.) and online shopping and has invested in AI capabilities through Azure OpenAI (Microsoft, 2025) and a cloud-first infrastructure (NTT DATA, n.d.). However, the company isn't using this data effectively for personalization. Marketing campaigns send the same offers to everyone instead of personalizing based on individual shopping habits. As Adobe (n.d.) highlights, businesses need AI-powered insights to deliver true personalization at scale.
- **Justification:** Customers today expect brands to know them and make relevant recommendations. When Carrefour sends generic offers, customers ignore them. Meanwhile, competitors using AI for personalization are building stronger customer relationships and selling more.
- **Impact on Business Objectives:**
 - **Objective 2 (Enhance Customer Experience):** Personalization is key to a great customer experience. Without it, Carrefour delivers a generic experience. This gap limits the potential of the "Enhance Customer Experience" objective. It also reduces the effectiveness of the SHARE loyalty program, as rewards and offers are not tailored to the individual, diminishing their perceived value.

Gap 4: Cloud Security Needs to Be More Proactive

- **Description:** With Carrefour rapidly migrating 382 workloads to the cloud across GCP, Azure, and OCI (NTT DATA, n.d.; Oracle Blogs, 2021), the company's digital attack surface has expanded significantly. The current security posture, developed in accordance with UAE data protection law (Carrefour Group, n.d.), wasn't designed for the dynamic and distributed nature of a multi-cloud environment. As a result, existing defenses may not be fully equipped to address the evolving risks this new landscape brings. Palo Alto Networks (2025) emphasizes that modern cloud environments require continuous monitoring and automated security to prevent misconfigurations and detect threats in real-time.
- **Justification:** A data breach would be devastating. It would leak customer information, damage trust, and cost millions. As Carrefour expands in the cloud, security must become more proactive to prevent incidents before they occur.

- **Impact on Business Objectives:**

- **Objective 2 (Enhance Customer Experience):** A security breach destroys customer trust completely.
- **Objective 1 (Lead in Digital Transformation):** Digital growth without proper security is risky.
- **Objective 3 (Drive Operational Excellence):** A security incident causes major operational disruption.

IT/Business Alignment Strategies and Actions

Proposed Solution for Gap 1: Poor Connection Between Online and In-Store Shopping

Possible Alternatives:

- **Alternative 1 Use Salesforce Commerce Cloud:** This is a powerful platform used by many retailers, but it's expensive and can be complicated to integrate with Carrefour's existing systems like SAP.
- **Alternative 2 Build a custom solution on Google Cloud (GCP):** This would give Carrefour complete control and flexibility since it can be built exactly to their needs. However, it would require a large development team and take 2-3 years to build, which is too slow.
- **Alternative 3 Adobe Experience Platform (AEP) (Selected):** AEP provides a complete set of tools for managing customer data, personalizing experiences, and guiding customer journeys (Adobe, n.d.). It creates a real-time, unified customer profile which makes it the best choice to connect Carrefour's online and in-store shopping, and it works well with Carrefour's existing GCP and SAP systems.

How This Solution Addresses the Gap:

AEP will fix the disconnected shopping experience by creating a single customer profile that combines data from all channels (Adobe, n.d.), including the SHARE loyalty program (SHARE Rewards, n.d.). When a customer shops online, their information and preferences will be available to store staff. When they buy in-store, their loyalty points update online instantly. This enables seamless experiences like buying online and returning in-store, with consistent promotions everywhere. Customers will feel recognized whether they shop on the app, website, or in person.

Implementation Recommendations

- **Phase 1 (0-6 months):** Plan and design. Map out all customer data sources including POS systems, the e-commerce website, the SHARE app, and any other places customer data lives. Design how AEP will connect to each one.
- **Phase 2 (6-12 months):** Set up AEP's Real-time Customer Data Platform. Start bringing customer data in from different sources and combining it into unified profiles. Test to make sure data is flowing correctly.
- **Phase 3 (12-18 months):** Launch personalization features. Start with basic online and in-store shopping features use cases like "buy online, return in-store." Then roll out personalized campaigns and recommendations based on the unified customer data.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

KPI	Target	Measurement method
Cross-Channel Shopping Rate	Increase by 30% in 18 months	Percentage of customers who shop across more than one channel.
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)	Achieving an average score of 85%	Post-interaction surveys across all channels.

Proposed Solution for Gap 2: Reliance on Manual Processes in Supply Chain

Possible Alternatives:

- **Alternative 1 Expand Take off Technologies Micro-Fulfilment Centers (MFCs):** This works well for last-mile delivery to customers (Zawya, 2021), but it doesn't fix the upstream problems like forecasting demand and managing warehouse inventory.
- **Alternative 2 Implement Blue Yonder Supply Chain Platform:** This is a complete supply chain solution used by many large retailers, but replacing all existing systems would be very disruptive and expensive.
- **Alternative 3 SAP Integrated Business Planning (IBP) + Expansion of MFCs (Selected):** This hybrid approach adds SAP's AI-powered demand forecasting module to Carrefour's existing SAP systems, while continuing to roll out more MFCs for last-mile delivery (Zawya, 2021). It builds on what Carrefour already has instead of replacing everything. This approach would also leverage Carrefour's existing data infrastructure, which already processes operational data 3x faster with IBM Netezza (IBM, n.d.).

How This Solution Addresses the Gap:

SAP IBP will automate the manual forecasting and planning tasks that people currently do with

spreadsheets. It will predict demand more accurately and automatically suggest when to order from suppliers and how much. This reduces human error and stock problems. At the same time, more MFCs mean faster delivery to customers with less manual packing and handling (Zawya, 2021). Together with inventory robots already deployed in stores (Simbe Robotics, n.d.), these solutions move Carrefour from a manual, reactive supply chain to an automated, predictive one. Less manual work means lower costs, fewer errors, and faster delivery.

Implementation Recommendations

- **Phase 1 (0-6 months):** Set up SAP IBP for demand forecasting. Connect it to sales data so it can start learning patterns. Also identify the next 10 locations where new MFCs should be built based on order volume.
- **Phase 2 (6-18 months):** Build and launch the 10 new MFCs. Connect SAP IBP to warehouse systems so that when inventory runs low, it automatically triggers restocking.
- **Phase 3 (18-24 months):** Create a fully automated system where store shelves are restocked automatically based on IBP forecasts, with minimal human involvement.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

KPI	Target	Measurement method
Order Fulfillment Time	Reduce average time by 40%	Time from online order placement to customer delivery.
Inventory Accuracy	Achieve 99% accuracy	Compare what the system says is in stock vs. what is actually on the shelves

Proposed Solution for Gap 3: Not Using Customer Data for Personalization

Possible Alternatives:

- **Alternative 1 Expand Azure OpenAI:** This is powerful for specific AI tasks like analyzing customer feedback (Microsoft, 2025), but it's not a complete personalization solution on its own and would need other tools added.
- **Alternative 2 Use Amazon Personalize:** This is a strong personalization platform, but it would tie Carrefour more closely to Amazon (a competitor) and doesn't integrate as well with Carrefour's existing Google Cloud systems.
- **Alternative 3 Google Recommendations AI + Azure OpenAI (Selected):** This approach combines the strengths of both platforms. Google Recommendations AI works natively with Carrefour's GCP environment (NTT DATA, n.d.) for real-time product recommendations, while Azure OpenAI (Microsoft, 2025) handles more complex tasks like generating

personalized email content and customer service responses. This builds on Carrefour's existing cloud investments.

How This Solution Addresses the Gap:

Google Recommendations AI will analyze customer browsing and purchase history in real-time to suggest relevant products on the website and app. For example, if a customer frequently buys organic products, they'll see organic recommendations first. Azure OpenAI will create personalized marketing content like emails and push notifications tailored to each customer's interests (Microsoft, 2025). Together with data from the SHARE loyalty program (SHARE Rewards, n.d.), these tools transform Carrefour's generic marketing into a personalized experience where every customer feels like the brand knows them, which increases engagement and sales.

Implementation Recommendations

- **Phase 1 (0-3 months):** Gather all real-time customer behaviour data (clicks, views, items added to cart) into one data stream on Google Cloud.
- **Phase 2 (3-9 months):** Train Google Recommendations AI models using historical and real-time customer data. Also develop templates for personalized emails and notifications using Azure OpenAI.
- **Phase 3 (9-12 months):** Launch real-time product recommendations on the website and app. Start sending AI-generated personalized campaigns to customers based on their individual shopping patterns.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

KPI	Target	Measurement method
Click-Through Rate (CTR) on Recommendations	Achieve a 15% CTR	Percentage of customers who click on a recommended product when they see it
Average Order Value (AOV)	Increase AOV by 25% for personalized sessions	Compare order values of sessions with personalization and sessions without

Proposed Solution for Gap 4: Cloud Security Needs to Be More Proactive

Possible Alternatives:

- **Alternative 1 Use Microsoft Defender for Cloud:** This works great for the Azure part of Carrefour's systems, but it doesn't give full visibility across Google Cloud (GCP) and Oracle Cloud (OCI) which Carrefour also uses (NTT DATA, n.d.; Oracle Blogs, 2021).
- **Alternative 2 Use Google Cloud Security Command Center:** Since Carrefour has many systems on GCP (NTT DATA, n.d.), this would work well for that environment. However, it

would need additional tools to monitor Azure and OCI, making security management more complicated.

- **Alternative 3 Use Palo Alto Networks Prisma Cloud (Selected):** This is a single platform that works across all cloud providers (GCP, Azure, and OCI). It monitors security continuously, checks for misconfigurations, and protects cloud workloads all in one place without needing separate tools for each cloud (Palo Alto Networks, 2025). This aligns with Carrefour's existing security posture, developed in accordance with UAE data protection law (Carrefour Group, n.d.).

How This Solution Addresses the Gap:

Prisma Cloud will solve the reactive security problem by giving Carrefour continuous, real-time visibility across its entire multi-cloud environment (Palo Alto Networks, 2025), including the 382 workloads already migrated (NTT DATA, n.d.). Instead of finding out about security issues after they happen, the platform will automatically detect misconfigurations, unusual activity, and potential threats as they occur. It can even block risky configurations before they are deployed. This shifts security from "fixing problems later" to "preventing problems before they start," building on the foundation of Carrefour's existing commitment to data protection regulations (Carrefour Group, n.d.). With all cloud environments monitored from one place, the security team can work more efficiently and respond to threats in minutes instead of hours or days.

Implementation Recommendations

- **Phase 1 (0-3 months):** Deploy Prisma Cloud across all cloud environments (GCP, Azure, OCI) in monitoring mode first. Run a full assessment to identify existing risks, misconfigurations, and compliance gaps.
- **Phase 2 (3-9 months):** Fix the highest-risk issues found in phase 1. Set up automated security checks in the development process so that new applications can't be deployed with security misconfigurations.
- **Phase 3 (9-12 months):** Connect Prisma Cloud to Carrefour's Security Operations Center so the security team gets real-time alerts. Enable automated responses for common threats to stop attacks quickly without waiting for manual action.

KPI	Target	Measurement method
Mean Time to Detect (MTTD)	Less than 10 minutes for critical threats	Time between when a security threat happens and when the security team finds out about it
Vulnerability Remediation Time	Less than 48 hours for critical vulnerabilities	Time taken to fix critical security issues in cloud systems

Part 2: Suggested Outline for the Industry Framework

Section 1: Framework Selection

The selected framework for **Carrefour** is a hybrid model combining **COBIT 2019** and **ITIL 4**. Different frameworks were reviewed before making the final decision. ITIL 4 focuses on IT service management and provides best practices for delivering and supporting IT services such as incident, problem, and change management (AXELOS, 2019). COBIT 2019 focuses on IT governance and helps organizations align IT with business goals, manage risks, and ensure compliance (ISACA, 2019). **ISO/IEC 27001** mainly focuses on information security, so it does not fully cover governance and service management needs (ISO, 2022).

The hybrid approach was selected because Carrefour needs both strong governance and effective daily IT operations. COBIT 2019 helps management ensure IT investments support business objectives, risks are controlled, and performance is monitored (ISACA, 2019). ITIL 4 helps improve service quality, reliability, and continuous improvement in daily IT activities (AXELOS, 2019). Using both frameworks together helps organizations improve governance while also improving service delivery, which is especially important in large digital retail environments (De Haes & Van Grembergen, 2020).

Retail companies such as **Walmart** and **Tesco** have used a combination of IT governance and IT service management frameworks to improve IT performance, risk management, and digital transformation outcomes (Gartner, 2023). This supports the justification for selecting the hybrid framework for Carrefour. To implement the selected hybrid framework, specific COBIT components and ITIL practices will be applied.

COBIT 2019 Components

The implementation will focus on important COBIT governance domains (ISACA, 2019):

- **APO02 (Manage Strategy):** Helps ensure IT supports business goals and digital strategy. This aligns IT initiatives with Carrefour's overall business direction.
- **APO12 (Manage Risk):** Helps identify and manage IT risks related to cloud, e-commerce, and digital systems. This improves proactive risk management.
- **BAI03 (Manage Solutions Identification):** Supports evaluation and implementation of new IT solutions and digital investments.
- **DSS05 (Manage Security Services):** Ensures security controls are implemented and strengthens cloud security governance.

ITIL 4 Practices

Key ITIL practices that will be implemented include (AXELOS, 2019):

- **Incident Management:** Helps restore services quickly after disruptions and improves reliability.
- **Problem Management:** Helps identify root causes and reduce repeated incidents.
- **Change Management:** Helps introduce new digital solutions with minimal disruption to business operations.
- **Service Level Management:** Helps ensure IT services meet agreed performance targets.

These practices help improve service quality, reduce downtime, and support consistent digital service delivery (AXELOS, 2019).

Scope Boundaries

The framework will cover all IT services supporting Carrefour retail operations, including e-commerce platforms, ERP systems, and cloud infrastructure. Systems fully managed by third-party vendors may be excluded from the initial phase. Other Majid Al Futtaim business units are not included unless shared services are involved.

Overall, the COBIT 2019 and ITIL 4 combination is suitable for Carrefour because it supports governance, risk management, and daily IT operations in a large digital retail environment (De Haes & Van Grembergen, 2020).

Section 2: Framework Implementation

The implementation aims to improve IT governance and IT service management across Carrefour. The main goals are to create an IT governance committee, implement key COBIT processes for strategy and risk management, and improve ITIL practices such as incident, problem, and change management. The implementation will start with critical systems such as e-commerce platforms and SAP.

The implementation will apply the selected COBIT domains (APO02, APO12, BAI03, DSS05) and ITIL practices to connect governance design with daily IT operations. This integrated approach improves service quality, risk control, and digital transformation outcomes (De Haes & Van Grembergen, 2020; Gartner, 2023).

Implementation Phases

1. **Assessment & Design:** Review current processes and design the integrated framework.
2. **Pilot Implementation:** Apply the framework to selected critical systems.
3. **Full Rollout:** Expand implementation across business units with training.
4. **Continuous Improvement:** Perform regular reviews, audits, and maturity assessments.

The implementation is expected to take around **24 months**, with an estimated cost of **USD 1.5–2.5 million**, including consulting, training, and tools. Required resources include a project manager, process owners, external consultants, and HR support for training and change management.

Implementation Plan:

Process	Framework Area	Owner	Timeline	Estimated Cost	Rationale
APO02 Strategy	COBIT	IT Steering Committee	Months 1–3	Low	Align IT with business strategy
APO12 Risk	COBIT	Risk Manager	Months 2–6	Medium	Improve IT risk management
BAI03 Solutions	COBIT	PMO	Months 3–9	Medium	Support digital project governance
DSS05 Security	COBIT	Security Team	Months 3–12	High	Improve security controls
Change Management	ITIL	IT Operations	Months 4–12	Medium	Implement changes safely
Incident Management	ITIL	Service Desk	Months 4–24	Medium	Improve service reliability

This plan helps Carrefour implement the framework step by step with clear responsibilities, timelines, and expected improvements.

TOGAF and ITG Framework Integration

The Role of TOGAF in Carrefour's Strategy

As mentioned earlier, Carrefour relies on the TOGAF framework to guide its technological infrastructure, which is a key part of its strategy (Majid Al Futtain Careers, 2025). TOGAF provides a structured and systematic approach to organizing and managing the company's complex technology environment.

It provides a clear roadmap illustrating how all of Carrefour's technological components work together, from core SAP systems and Google Cloud infrastructure to customer-facing applications (NTT DATA, 2024).. The goal is to ensure that every technological decision directly contributes to Carrefour's key business objectives, such as enhancing customer experience and achieving operational excellence. It provides the architectural foundation upon which all other management and governance processes are built.

The Relationship between TOGAF and the Selected Frameworks

Effective IT management in any organization requires the integration of several frameworks, each focusing on a different aspect. The frameworks we have chosen (TOGAF, COBIT, and ITIL) are designed to complement each other, creating a comprehensive system that links strategic planning with operational implementation.

- **TOGAF: Enterprise Architecture Framework**

The core function of TOGAF is to design and structure technological architecture. It answers the question of **what** is the desired form of the infrastructure, applications, and data to ensure they are cohesive and capable of supporting future business growth (The Open Group, 2018).

- **COBIT: The Governance Framework**

COBIT operates at a higher level, focusing on IT governance and management (ISACA, 2019). It acts as a bridge between business objectives and the IT department, answering the question of **why** the company should invest in a particular technological initiative and how to ensure it delivers value and its risks are effectively managed.

- **ITIL: The Service Management Framework**

ITIL focuses on the operational side, offering best practices for managing day-to-day IT services (AXELOS, 2019). It answers the question of **how** these services will be delivered, supported, and maintained efficiently to ensure their quality and reliability for users.

This integrated model provides a comprehensive approach to IT management. TOGAF provides the architectural blueprint, COBIT provides the control and governance framework to guide and monitor

technical activities, while ITIL provides the operational processes for managing the resulting services. This integration ensures that Carrefour's IT function is not only aligned with the business strategy but is also governed, managed, and operated in a structured and efficient manner.

Impact of Integration with Clear Examples

The true value of integrating TOGAF, COBIT, and ITIL becomes clear when applied to a strategic project. They create an integrated system that ensures strategy, technical architecture, and day-to-day operations remain consistently aligned. We will examine how this integrated model would be applied to the project proposed for:

Example 1: Implementing the Unified Customer Experience Platform (Solution for Gap 1)

For a complex project like the new Adobe platform, the frameworks provide a clear path to success:

- **TOGAF:** First, TOGAF is used to design the architectural blueprint, outlining its integration with SAP and Google Cloud systems (NTT DATA, 2024), ensuring it fits perfectly into the company's technological landscape.
- **COBIT:** Next, COBIT provides business governance. Guided by processes like BAI03 (Manage Solutions Identification and Build), it ensures the project has a strong business case, that its budget is approved and controlled, and that risks (like data privacy) are managed (ISACA, 2019).
- **ITIL:** Finally, once the platform is live, ITIL manages the platform on a daily basis, handling technical incidents and managing any future updates without disrupting service (AXELOS, 2019).

Impact: This integrated approach ensures the platform is well-designed (according to TOGAF standards), strategically valuable (according to COBIT standards), and reliable for long-term users (according to ITIL standards).

Example 2: Cloud Security and Migration Governance (Solution for Gap 4)

When migrating applications to the cloud, frameworks ensure that the process is secure and efficient:

- **TOGAF:** First, TOGAF is used to design the cloud architecture, helping the company to choose the right services from providers such as Google and Azure to securely host its applications (NTT DATA, 2024; Oracle, 2021).
- **COBIT:** Next, the COBIT framework provides security and supplier governance. Guided by processes like DSS05 (Manage Security Services), it establishes the rules for cloud security and ensures that the company's agreements with Google and Microsoft align with Carrefour's business needs and performance standards (ISACA, 2019; Microsoft, 2025).

- **ITIL:** Finally, ITIL handles the practical side of the migration process. It provides a structured process for moving applications with minimal disruption and then handles daily security monitoring and incident response once they have been moved to the cloud.

Impact: This ensures that the transition to cloud computing is not just a technological shift, but a well-structured, secure, and professionally managed process that reduces business risks.

Status of ITIM (CLO5)

Current ITIM Status and Maturity

Based on the evidence of significant, successful, and ROI-driven technology investments, Carrefour is currently at Stage 3: "Developing a Consistent Investment Portfolio." The company has moved beyond ad-hoc project selection and is making strategic investments in platforms like GCP (NTT DATA, n.d.), IBM Netezza (IBM, n.d.), and Azure OpenAI (Microsoft, 2025). There is a clear focus on creating business value and a process for selecting and managing major projects.

Analysis of Current IT Investments and ROI

Carrefour has made several high-impact investments in information technology with demonstrable returns

Investment	Description	Estimated ROI & Business Value
1. Google Cloud Platform (GCP)	A complete migration of existing on-site systems to a scalable, cloud-native infrastructure to enhance flexibility and performance.	ROI: High (not quantifiable but offers flexibility and scalability). Value: Enabled the business to handle peak demand and accelerated time-to-market (NTT DATA, n.d.).
2. IBM Netezza Performance Server	A high-performance data warehouse and analytics platform implemented to accelerate data processing and business intelligence.	ROI: Tangible and significant. Value: Made decision-making 2x faster, improved response time by 100%, and processes operational data 3x faster (IBM, n.d.).
3. Microsoft Azure OpenAI Service	AI service has been implemented to automatically analyze large quantities of customer feedback and sentiments from various sources.	ROI: USD 1 million in annual savings. Value: Reduced feedback processing time by 97% and enhanced customer targeting (Microsoft, 2025).
4. Genesys Cloud Contact Center	A modern, cloud-based solution for managing all customer interactions across different channels, replacing legacy systems.	ROI: 43% cost savings in contact center operations. Value: Streamlined customer service and improved agent productivity (Genesys, n.d.).

Future IT Investment Plan

To move from its current position to Stage 4 .Optimizing the Investment Portfolio, Carrefour needs to formalize its investment management process to encompass its entire lifecycle. This requires adopting a structured four-stage approach to all future technology investments:

Planning phase: The IT Governance Committee will create a multi-year investment roadmap. This roadmap will be directly based on the strategic initiatives that were identified in this report (such as the unified customer experience platform and supply chain automation), with a detailed feasibility study developed for each initiative.

Selection phase: A formal project selection process will be established. Proposed projects will be evaluated and prioritized based on clear criteria such as strategic alignment, return on investment, and risk. This ensures the company selects the best mix of projects, not just good individual projects.

Control phase: A portfolio management tool will be implemented to monitor the performance of all active projects in real time. This will provide the governance committee with a clear view of the budget, timeline, and value being achieved.

Evaluation phase: A post-implementation review process will be activated. Six months after the launch of any project, the actual return on investment will be measured and compared to the original feasibility study, and lessons learned will be used to improve future planning.

This mature process will initially be applied to the key investment pillars identified in this strategic plan:

- Unified Commerce Platform (Adobe AEP)
- Supply Chain Automation (SAP IBP)
- AI-Powered Personalization (Google AI)
- Proactive Cloud Security (Prisma Cloud)

By implementing this structured process and focusing it on this strategic portfolio of projects, Carrefour will create a cycle of continuous improvement. This will not only ensure that these specific projects deliver maximum value but will also build the organizational capacity to manage all future technological investments as a strategic portfolio that generates real value for the business.

Conclusion

Majid Al Futtaim Retail has successfully established Carrefour as a leader in the regional retail market (Vel & Gomišček, 2021), thanks to its ambitious and strategic investments in technology. The company's clear vision for digital transformation, supported by a cloud-first strategy (NTT DATA, n.d.) and partnerships with global technology leaders (pawaon, 2023; IBM, n.d.), provides a solid foundation for future growth. However, to maintain its competitive edge and fully achieve its business objectives, the company must now focus on bridging the critical gaps identified in unified customer experience, supply chain automation, and AI-powered personalization.

The implementation of the strategic initiatives proposed in this report, under an integrated framework combining COBIT and ITIL, will provide the necessary structure and discipline to achieve this. By maturing its IT investment management process and adopting a portfolio-based approach, Carrefour can ensure that every dirham invested in technology achieves maximum strategic value.

This comprehensive plan, when effectively implemented, will empower Carrefour not only to navigate the complexities of the modern retail landscape but to shape its future, delivering unparalleled value to its customers and stakeholders for years to come.

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Appendix

Plagiarism Result

Introduction and Company Background

This document explains the IT Strategic Plan and Governance Framework for Majid Al Futtaim Retail (Carrefour). It was created to guide the company's technology leaders and make sure IT projects support the main business goals, follow rules and regulations, and give the best value to technology investments over the next 3 to 5 years.

Company background:

Company Name: Majid Al Futtaim Retail

Brand: Carrefour (under an exclusive franchise agreement)

Size: Majid Al Futtaim Retail has more than 390 Carrefour stores in 16 countries. It employs over 37,000 people and serves more than 750,000 customers every day (Majid Al Futtaim, 2026). The parent company, Majid Al Futtaim, earned 9.2 billion USD in revenue in 2024 (Majid Al Futtaim, 2025).

Location: Headquartered in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, with operations across the



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Rubric

Group Project Rubric [Task-specific RUBRIC]

		Absent (F)	Insufficient (1-59.49%) (F)	Emerging (60-69.49%) (D/D+/C-)	Satisfactory (70-76.49%) (C/C+)	Competent (77-86.49%) (B-/B/B+)	Mastering (87-100%) (A-/A)
			1-1.19 marks	1.2-1.39 marks	1.4-1.53 marks	1.54-1.73 marks	1.73-2 marks
Group Grading [50%]	Introduction and Company Background (CLO2) [2 Marks]		Basic details about the company. No Business Objectives have been identified	Some but not all of the following: Basic details about the company. And objectives are clearly identified	Most but not all of the following: - Adequate details about the company including Business vision, mission and Business - Partial details of IT department are not given.	All of the following: - All the required details about the company - company name, services or products provided, size, location, customers, Business vision, mission and Business Objectives is provided. - IT Department details are partially complete	All of the following: - All the required details about the company - company name, services or products provided, size, location, customers, Business vision, mission and Business Objectives is provided. - IT Department details are complete.
			1-4.76 marks	4.8-5.56 marks	5.6-6.12 marks	6.16-6.92 marks	6.96-8 marks

	IT Situation Assessment (CLO2)[8 Marks]		- No IT Organization Profile is defined. No details given on any of the following items: - service management Approach - IT and Business Alignment Issues - IT Leadership profile - Current IT Governance Status - Enterprise Architecture	- IT Organization Profile is defined but are incomplete and lack details. - Most of the items miss from the following list - IT service management Approach - IT and Business Alignment Issues - IT Leadership profile - Current IT Governance Status - Enterprise Architecture	- IT Organization Profile is adequately described. 3 or less from the following list have been adequately defined with relevant information: - IT service management Approach - IT and Business Alignment Issues - IT Leadership profile - Current IT Governance Status - Enterprise Architecture	- IT Organization Profile is clearly described. 4 from the following list have been adequately defined with relevant information: - IT service management Approach - IT and Business Alignment Issues - IT Leadership profile - Current IT Governance Status - Enterprise Architecture	- IT Organization Profile has been described in complete detail. - Clearly defined and relevant information of 4 or more from the following list: - IT service management Approach - IT and Business Alignment Issues - IT Leadership profile - Current IT Governance Status - Enterprise Architecture
			1.0-5.94 marks	6.0-6.94 marks	7.0-7.64 marks	7.7-8.64 marks	8.7-10 marks

	Major IT & Business Gap Analysis (CLO4) [10 marks]		- IT or Business Gaps Analysis is incomplete - No IT/Business Gaps identified	Some but not all of the following: - Limited IT or Business Gaps Analysis - Poor IT/Business Gaps identified	Most but not all of the following: - Adequate IT or Business Gaps Analysis - Adequate IT/Business Gaps identified	All of the following: - Adequate IT or Business Gaps Analysis - Adequate IT/Business Gaps identified - Includes some information on why it is a Gap and how it will impact the Business Objective/s	All of the following: - Comprehensive IT or Business Gaps Analysis - Thorough IT/Business Gaps discussed - For each Gap a clear and detailed explanation of why it is a Gap and the impact on Business Objective/s is provided.
			1 - 2.97 marks	3 – 3.47 marks	3.50 – 3.82 marks	3.87 – 4.32 marks	4.37 – 5.00 marks

	IT/Business Alignment Strategies and Actions (Strategy Roadmap/plan) (CLO5) [5 Marks]		- No possible alternative and the selected solution for each identified gap is incomplete - Student has an accumulation of errors in grammar, usage, and mechanics that distract or interfere with meaning	Some but not all of the following: - Identification of the possible alternative and the selected solution for each identified gap is complete and/or details. - Many distracting errors in grammar, usage, and mechanics	Most but not all of the following: - Discussion of the possible alternative and the selected solution - Explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation will address and improve the identified gap - Some distracting errors in grammar, usage, and mechanics	All of the following: - Discussion of the possible alternative and the selected solution for each identified gap is adequate. - Explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation for each solution will address and improve the identified gap - Few distracting errors in grammar, usage, and mechanics	All of the following: - Discussion of the possible alternatives and the selected solution for each identified gap. - Clear explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation for each solution will address and improve the identified gap. - KPIs per selected solution have been identified with all relevant information. - Is free of distracting errors in grammar, usage, and mechanics
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			1 - 8.92 Marks	9.00 - 10.42 Marks	10.50 - 11.47 Marks	11.62 - 12.97 Marks	13.12 - 15.00 Marks
	Framework Selection & Planning (CLO3) [15 Marks]		- Framework Selected is in appropriate and not justified - Poor overview of the selected Framework	Some but not all of the following: - Appropriate Framework selected with no justification - Framework overview have been stated with lacking descriptions.	Most but not all of the following: - Appropriate Framework selected poor adequate justification - Framework overview is adequately described.	All of the following: - Selected the most appropriate Framework with adequate justification - Framework overview is adequately described.	All of the following: - Selected the most appropriate Framework with adequate justification and supporting success stories as examples - Framework principles / components/ domains have been described in detail and includes a complete scope description with clearly defined relevant information like boundaries or exclusions of the Framework.
			1 - 2.97 marks	3 – 3.47 marks	3.50 – 3.82 marks	3.87 – 4.32 marks	4.37– 5.00 marks

	ToGAF and ITG Framework (CLO3) [05 Marks]		No details is given on relationship between ToGAF and selected Framework	- Details on Implementation of the selected Framework in relationship with TOGAF is incomplete with insufficient justification. - Explanation lacks discussion on relationship between TOGAF and the selected Framework	- Details on Implementation of the selected Framework in relationship with TOGAF is adequately explained. - Integration of ToGAF with the selected Framework is explained without use of clear examples and impact of such integration is not highlighted.	- Details on Implementation of the selected Framework in relationship with TOGAF is explained sufficiently. - Integration of ToGAF with the selected Framework is explained with sufficient details with incomplete examples. The impact of integration between ToGAF and selected Framework is highlighted adequately.	- Details on Implementation of the selected Framework in relationship with TOGAF is explained sufficiently. - Integration of ToGAF with the selected Framework is explained details using the clear examples of its applications in the organization. The impact of integration between ToGAF and selected Framework is highlighted clearly.
			1 - 2.97 marks	3 – 3.47 marks	3.50 – 3.82 marks	3.87– 4.32 marks	4.37–5.00 marks
	ITIM Status (CLO5) [5 Marks]		ITIM Status description is missing	ITIM Status is briefly discussed, and description lacks details about future IT investment plans.	ITIM status is explained using at least one example of the current IT investments. ROI of at least one investment is described. However, the explanations lack descriptions of future IT Investments.	ITIM status is clearly explained using the at least two examples of the current IT investments. ROI of at least two investments is described. Some details of future IT Investments are given.	ITIM status is clearly explained with at least four examples of the current IT investments. ROI of minimum four current IT investments are clearly described. Future IT

							Investments are explained in detail using the four phases of ITIM.
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Follow-up questions and discussion [42%] [CLOs] [42 Marks = CLO2 – 8 marks, CLO3 – 18 marks, CLO4 – 8 Marks, CLO5 – 8 marks]

		0 Marks	1-4.76 marks	4.8-5.56 marks	5.6-6.12 marks	6.16-6.92 marks	6.96-8 marks
Individual Grading [50%]	Individual Demo - Oral Communication [8%]		- Communicates with a limited sense of audience and purpose (No eye contact, no body language, and no poise) - Communicates information and ideas with limited clarity - Uses language with limited accuracy and effectiveness Tension and nervousness are obvious; has trouble recovering from mistakes	Some but not all of the following: - Communicates with a clear sense of audience and purpose (Eye contact, body language, and poise) - Communicates information and ideas with considerable clarity - Uses Language with considerable accuracy and effectiveness Makes minor mistakes, but quickly recovers from them; displays little or no tensions	Most but not all of the following: - Communicates with a clear sense of audience and purpose (Eye contact, body language, and poise) - Communicates information and ideas with considerable clarity - Uses language with considerable accuracy and effectiveness Makes minor mistakes, but quickly recovers from them; displays little or no tensions	All of the following: - Communicates with a clear sense of audience and purpose (Eye contact, body language, and poise) - Communicates information and ideas with considerable clarity - Uses language with considerable accuracy and effectiveness Makes minor mistakes, but quickly recovers from them; displays little or no tensions	All of the following: - Communicates with a strong sense of audience and purpose (holds attention with the use of direct eye contact, seldom looking at notes) - Communicates information and ideas with a high degree of clarity - Uses Language with a high degree of accuracy and effectiveness Student displays relaxed, self-confident, with no mistakes

Individual Follow-up Questions CLO2 - CLO5 [42 MARKS]							
CLO2 (2 Marks)	0 Marks	1-1.19 marks	1.2-1.39 marks	1.4-1.53 marks	1.54-1.73 marks	1.73-2 marks	
CLO2: Introduction and Company Background		Basic explanation about the company. No Business Objectives have been identified.	Basic explanation about the company. And objectives are clearly explained	Adequate explanation about the company including Business vision, mission and Business and partial details of IT department	Explanation of all the required details about the company are clearly explained - company name, services or products provided, size, location, customers, Business vision, mission and Business Objectives is provided.	Clear and articulate explanation of all the required details about the company - company name, services or products provided, size, location, customers, Business vision, mission and Business Objectives is provided. IT Department details are complete.	
CLO2 (6 Marks)	0 Marks	1-3.57 Marks	3.6 – 4.17 marks	4.20-4.59 marks	4.6 – 5.18 Marks	5.22 - 6 Marks	
CLO2: Situation Analysis	.	Vague or incorrect situation analysis	Basic analysis of the current (AS-IS) and the future (TO-BE) status.	Adequate analysis of the current (AS-IS) and the future (TO-BE) status.	Strong analysis of the current (AS-IS) and the future (TO-BE) status with use of relevant examples.	Strong analysis of the current (AS-IS) and the future (TO-BE) status using detailed, relevant criteria. Justifies analysis tools such as SWOT and Paint-Point Analysis.	
CLO3 (18 Marks)	0 Marks	0.01 - 10.7 Marks	10.71 - 12.5 Marks	12.51 - 13.76 Marks	13.77 - 15.55 Marks	15.56 - 18.00 Marks	
CLO3: Framework Selection & Planning	.	Struggles to explain and justify the selection of IT governance framework suitable for to address the issues faced by the	Basic explanation and justification of the selection of IT governance framework suitable for to address the issues faced by the	Adequate explanation and justification of the selection of IT governance framework suitable for to address the issues faced by the	Strong explanation and justification of the selection of IT governance framework suitable for to address the issues faced by the company and their	Expert understanding of IT governance frameworks, able to give detailed examples of its application in the organization. Expert understanding of ToGAF and ITG Framework,	

			company and their relevance. Struggles to explain ToGAF and ITG frameworks suitability to address the governance issues in the company.	company and their relevance. Basic explanation and justification of the relevance ToGAF and ITG Framework in addressing the issues faced by the company.	company and their relevance. Basic explanation and justification of the relevance ToGAF and ITG Framework in addressing the issues faced by the company.	relevance using relevant examples. Alternative frameworks discussed. Strong explanation and justification of the relevance ToGAF and ITG Framework in addressing the issues faced by the company. Alternative frameworks discussed.	able to give detailed examples of its application in the organization.
	CLO4 (8 Marks)	0 Marks	1-4.76 marks	4.8-5.56 marks	5.6-6.12 marks	6.16-6.92 marks	6.96-8 marks
	CLO4: Major IT & Business Gap Analysis		Inadequate explanation of IT/Business Gaps identified	Basic explanation of IT/Business Gaps identified.	Adequate explanation of IT/Business Gaps identified.	Strong explanation of IT/Business Gaps identified including some explanation on why it is a Gap and how it will impact the Business Objective/s	Comprehensive explanation of IT/Business Gaps identified, and for each Gap a clear and detailed explanation of why it is a Gap and the impact on Business Objective/s is provided.
	CLO5 (5 Marks)	0 Marks	1 - 2.97 marks	3 – 3.47 marks	3.50 – 3.82 marks	3.87 – 4.32 marks	4.37 – 5.00 marks
	CLO5: IT/Business Alignment Strategies and Actions (Strategy Roadmap/plan)		Struggles to explain of how the proposed implementation / recommendation will address and improve the identified gap	Basic explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation will address and improve the identified gap with no examples given.	Adequate explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation will address and improve the identified gap	Excellent explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation for each solution will address and improve the identified gap	Expert explanation of how the proposed implementation / recommendation for each solution will address and improve the identified gap with KPIs per selected

			with some examples given.		with some examples given.		solution explained with all relevant information.
	CLO5 (3 Marks)	0 Marks	1-1.78 marks	1.80 - 2.09 Marks	2.10-2.29 Marks	2.3 – 2.59 Marks	2.6 – 3 Marks
	CLO5: Status of ITIM		Unable to explain ITIM Status clearly.	Basic explanation of ITIM Status but unable to explain the future IT investment plans.	Adequate explanation of ITIM status using at least one example of the current IT investments.	Strong explanation of ITIM status using examples of the current IT investments. ROI of investments is clearly explained.	Expert explanation of ITIM status with examples of the current IT investments. ROI of current IT investments are clearly described. Future IT Investments are explained in detail.